

THE CURRENT BRIEFING OF

MERIDIAN

Twelve desks. One world.

MONDAY · 13 JULY 2026



THE WORLD

A third strike wave hits Iran — and Washington and Tehran can't agree if the strait is even open

THE MACRO DESK

The Fed's dot plot flips from cuts to hikes, and the market hasn't decided who's right

CURIOSITIES

Filmed alive for the first time: a shark whose lineage predates the dinosaurs' extinction

INSIDE THIS EDITION

TWELVE DESKS · ONE WORLD

What's confirmed, and what's merely declared

A week that resolved a surprising number of open questions — a World Cup bracket, a chart number, a ramen verdict, a decade-long rail loop — while one dispute over a stretch of water stayed stubbornly, sincerely, unresolved on both sides.

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FROM THE DESK

"The truth is rarely pure and never simple."

— Oscar Wilde, *The Importance of Being Earnest* (1895)

Wilde meant it as a joke about Victorian manners. This week it reads as a market note. CENTCOM says the Strait of Hormuz is open; the IRGC says it's closed — both spoken with total sincerity, both serving the speaker. Meanwhile a World Cup bracket, a Billboard number and a ramen verdict all resolved cleanly into plain fact. The skill this issue asked of every desk was the same: know which kind of statement you're holding.

THE STRIP — AS OF FRIDAY 10 JUL
CLOSE (ASIA MONDAY-OPEN
PENDING)

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	NOTE
STI	5,469.29	+0.65% Fri
S&P 500	7,575.39	+0.42% Fri
US 10Y	4.54%	eased off mid-week 4.57% high
DXY	100.97	steady
USD/SGD	1.2925	steady
Brent	~\$75–78	firm on Hormuz risk
Gold	\$4,119	flat on the week
BTC	\$64.3k	becalmed

Dated levels, held honestly — Brent's exact print is disputed across sources and reported as a range rather than guessed. Market data is explanation, not advice — see Macro, [p15](#).

THE WORLD · GULF CRISIS

Third strike wave hits Iran as Hormuz status splits into rival realities

Washington and Tehran traded a fresh round of attacks over the weekend, with Iranian strikes reaching five Gulf states. The Strait of Hormuz is now simultaneously "closed" and "open," depending on who is asked.

The United States struck Iran for a third time in a week, and Tehran answered before dawn on Sunday with drone and missile attacks reaching at least five Arab nations, including Kuwait, Jordan and Qatar. The exchange has plunged the eleven-day-old "ceasefire is over" standoff into its most dangerous phase yet, with the two sides now issuing flatly contradictory accounts of whether the world's most important oil chokepoint is even open.¹

Iran's Revolutionary Guard Corps declared the Strait of Hormuz closed to shipping again on Sunday. US Central Command said the opposite: "The Strait of Hormuz is open to all vessels seeking to lawfully transit the international waterway. Traffic is flowing." An independent maritime advisory group split the difference, reporting the strait's southern shipping route still passable despite Iran's declaration — but rating the threat level "severe," with mariners warned to expect naval radio hails and mine risk.²

The immediate trigger: an IRGC strike on a Cyprus-flagged container ship transiting the strait on 11 July, which set the vessel ablaze, left 23 crew stranded and one missing. Brent crude, which had slid below \$70 a barrel on 1 July on hopes the June ceasefire would hold, climbed back above \$76 on Friday — a weekly gain of 5 to 6 percent — after earlier spiking as high as \$78–80 on the first "ceasefire over" strikes. Doha-mediated talks on sanctions relief and roughly \$6bn in frozen Iranian funds resumed Saturday, but no outcome has been confirmed as strikes continue on a parallel track.³

WASHINGTON—

CNBC/REUTERS
FRAMING

US coverage centres CENTCOM's insistence that the strait remains functionally open and traffic is "flowing," framing Iran's closure claim as bluster while tracking the oil-price risk premium building into Brent futures.

DOHA/GULF—AL JAZEERA /
GCC FRAMING

Gulf-facing coverage leads with Iran's retaliation reaching five nations and Tehran's closure declaration, giving equal weight to the human cost. The GCC formally condemned Iran's "repeated heinous" attacks on Bahrain and Kuwait, naming strikes on the Saudi tanker Wadiyan and Qatari tanker *Al Rekayyat*, and called the UN Security Council to act.

BEIJING—GLOBAL
TIMES/XINHUA
FRAMING

Chinese state media has struck a rare balance — slamming the US military posture around Hormuz as "dangerous and irresponsible" while simultaneously pressing Iran to stop disrupting shipping. Roughly 40 percent of China's oil imports transit the strait.

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GULF NATIONS HIT BY IRANIAN STRIKES
IN THE LATEST RETALIATORY WAVE, PER
BLOOMBERG, 12 JUL

SOURCES · 1 Bloomberg, "US, Iran Trade Wave of Attacks as Tehran Says Hormuz Closed," 12 Jul 2026. 2 Bloomberg, "Hormuz Southern Route Open Despite Iran Claim, Maritime Group Says," 12 Jul 2026; Washington Times, 12 Jul 2026. 3 CNBC, 8 Jul 2026; Al Jazeera, 8 Jul 2026.

THE WORLD · IN BRIEF

Top-four bracket set in Dallas and Atlanta; Russia strikes Sumy and Odesa

World Cup semis confirmed. Argentina beat Switzerland 3-1 in extra time on 11 July — Mac Allister struck in the 10th minute, Ndoye equalised for Switzerland in the 67th, then Alvarez (112') and Lautaro Martínez (120+1') won it after Switzerland's Breel Embolo was sent off for a second yellow in the 72nd minute. It sets up Argentina against England.¹

The semifinal bracket is now complete: France face Spain on Tuesday 14 July at AT&T Stadium, Dallas; England face defending champions Argentina on Wednesday 15 July at Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta, both at 3pm ET. It is the first World Cup in which the top four FIFA-ranked teams have all reached the semifinals. The final remains set for 19 July.²

Ukraine. Russian missile and drone strikes killed eight people and wounded dozens across Ukraine over the weekend. Glide bombs hit a crowded area of Sumy, killing five and injuring 30; a separate strike on civilian infrastructure in Odesa killed two more. Ukrainian forces struck 21 Russian tankers, four tugboats, two dry-cargo ships and a dredger in the Sea of Azov in an asymmetric naval response.³

President Volodymyr Zelensky announced Prime Minister Yulia Svyrydenko — in post since July 2025 — is moving into a new role leading cooperation with Ukraine's key partners. Separately, state defence firm Ukroboronprom dismissed two officials following an investigation into a fatal ammunition-depot explosion during a Russian strike on the Kyiv suburb of Vyshneve. Zelensky said Ukraine is critically short of Patriot interceptor munitions and "largely unable to down ballistic missiles" over the past month.⁴

Inside the 8 July strikes. The US wave that first broke the ceasefire hit six Iranian locations — Iranshahr, Bandar Abbas, Konarak, Chabahar and Bushehr in the south and east, plus Aq Qala in the northeast — as part of roughly 90 targets struck in total. Trump made his "ceasefire is over" remarks while attending a NATO summit, adding that talks could continue but were "just a waste of time dealing with them." Pakistan and Qatar are both working behind the scenes to bring negotiators back to the table alongside the Doha channel.⁵

"The Strait of Hormuz is open to all vessels seeking to lawfully transit the international waterway. Traffic is flowing." — US Central Command, 12 July

\$70.44

WTI CRUDE FUTURES PRICE AFTER A 2.8% JUMP ON 8 JULY, TRACKING BRENT'S 3% RISE TO \$74.16 THE SAME SESSION

IN BRIEF

GCC solidarity clause — Gulf bloc reaffirmed that any attack on one member state "is a direct attack on all," 9 Jul.

Oil — Brent crude back above \$76/barrel Friday, erasing the post-MOU slide to sub-\$70 seen 1 Jul.

Doha track — Talks on frozen Iranian funds (~\$6bn of a wider ~\$12bn) resumed Saturday; no confirmed outcome yet.

Tanker attack — Cyprus-flagged container ship set ablaze in Hormuz, 11 Jul; 23 crew stranded, one missing.

China's line — Beijing wants the strait reopened fast: roughly 40% of its oil imports transit Hormuz.

World Cup final — 19 July, venue and kickoff to be confirmed after semis.

Nuclear file — Inspector access remains a separate, unresolved sticking point in the Doha talks alongside the frozen-funds question.

UN appeal — GCC has renewed its call for the Security Council to take "a firm stance" guaranteeing safe transit through the strait.

Mediators — US envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner have led the Doha channel opposite Iran's deputy foreign minister, Kazem Gharibabadi.

SOURCES · 1 ESPN; Al Jazeera Sport, 11–12 Jul 2026. 2 NBC Sports; Olympics.com, 12 Jul 2026. 3 The Moscow Times, 12 Jul 2026. 4 Kyiv Independent; Russia Matters, 12 Jul 2026. 5 NBC News; CNBC; NPR, 8 Jul 2026.

SINGAPORE · TRANSPORT

Circle Line closes the loop: CCL6 opens, cutting up to 10 minutes off Marina Bay trips

Three new stations — Keppel, Cantonment and Prince Edward Road — opened for passenger service on Sunday, completing a 39km, 33-station ring that finally links HarbourFront directly to Marina Bay.

Circle Line Stage 6 opened for passenger service on Sunday, 12 July, completing the full Circle Line loop after years of staged construction. The three new stations — Keppel, Cantonment and Prince Edward Road — close the gap between HarbourFront and Marina Bay, giving commuters a direct route through the city's southern core that was not previously possible on the network. A public preview of the three stations had run on 4 July, offering free rides ahead of the official start.¹

The completed Circle Line now spans 39 kilometres across 33 stations, with 12 interchanges connecting to every other line on the network — the North-South and East-West Lines, North East Line, Downtown Line and Thomson-East Coast Line. LTA and SMRT say the new closed loop delivers time savings of up to 10 minutes for journeys through and around Marina Bay. The opening closes out a project years in the making and gives the network its first fully-closed rail loop.²

LTA and SMRT had flagged CCL6 as moving into its "next phase of works" ahead of a targeted first-half-2026 opening as far back as August last year, with construction milestones tracked publicly in the run-up to Sunday's start. The free public preview on 4 July ran from 9:30am to 9pm, letting residents walk through Keppel, Cantonment and Prince Edward Road stations before the paid service began — a now-familiar LTA playbook for major line openings.³

39km

LENGTH OF THE NOW-COMPLETE
CIRCLE LINE ACROSS 33 STATIONS, 12
OF THEM INTERCHANGES

THE CHATTER

Commuter boards and transport blogs flagged the direct HarbourFront–Marina Bay link as the practical win — cutting out transfers that previously routed travellers via the city interchanges.

ALSO IN SINGAPORE

Hoax bomb threat — 40-year-old man charged over fake threats to HTX and Parliament House sent 3 and 7 Jul; case adjourned to 16 Jul, no verdict yet.

Haze outlook — MSS flags El Niño (over 80% likelihood) plus a positive Indian Ocean Dipole developing Jul–Aug, echoing conditions behind 1997's record-dry year; SIIA has issued a red alert for H2 2026 haze risk. No live haze event yet.

Q2 GDP — MTI's advance estimate for second-quarter growth lands Tuesday 14 July, 8am — a day after this issue.

NDP 2026 — Main parade returns to National Stadium on 9 August for the first time since 2016, theme "Majulah Singapura, Go Beyond!," with previews on 25 Jul and 1 Aug and NDP's first indoor drone light show.

Maritime diplomacy — Singapore's IMO-adopted, 30-co-sponsor resolution on free Hormuz transit continues to draw notice amid the weekend's Gulf strikes, though no fresh follow-through action has been reported since adoption.

Trade data caution — June non-oil domestic export figures are not due from Enterprise Singapore until mid-July; treat any "June NODX" numbers in wider circulation now as unconfirmed.

PROPERTY · RESALE MARKET

HDB resale index falls for a second straight quarter — even as million-dollar flats hit a record share

Fresh Q2 data complicates the resale story: the official price index is down 0.3% quarter-on-quarter, but June's flash reading shows a market bifurcating between mature-estate trophy flats and a softer non-mature segment — even as a mega Bayshore GLS site and a new Lentor preview keep private supply flowing.

Singapore's HDB resale market has posted back-to-back quarterly price declines for the first time in almost seven years, with the official Resale Price Index down 0.3% quarter-on-quarter in Q2 2026 after Q1's 0.1% dip.¹ Yet June's transaction-level picture — the 99-SRX Flash Report — resists a simple cooling narrative: prices were flat month-on-month and year-on-year, even as a record 188 flats crossed the million-dollar mark, 8.8% of all deals, up from 166 in May.² Volume: an estimated 2,137 flats changed hands in June, down 0.1% from May and 6.1% lower year-on-year — fewer, pricier deals setting the tone even as the index retreats.²

The divergence sharpens by estate: mature estates rose 0.6% month-on-month in June even as non-mature estates slipped 0.3% — location, not the market overall, is now doing the work of holding values up.² Read against the quarterly RPI decline, this points to a two-speed resale market: trophy flats in established estates still clearing at record sums, while newer towns absorb the softening — a bifurcation a single index number can obscure.

Kingsford opened previews for Lentor Gardens Residences on 4 July (through 14 July): 499 units plus three shops and a childcare centre in the Lentor Hills precinct, indicative pricing \$2,250–2,350 psf, units from \$1.4xx million, booking day 18 July.³ On the government land side, Bayshore Drive — a 5.74ha mixed-use site with 1,280 homes integrated with Bedok South MRT — closes for tender Wednesday 15 July; analysts expect two to six bids, with a top bid estimated at \$1.15–2 billion, or \$1,150–1,300 psf ppr, accounting for over a third of homes planned for the wider Bayshore precinct.⁴

ALSO ON THE DESK

Balestier Regency — 4th-attempt tender closed 9 Jul, S\$255M guide; result still unreported.

High Point — 5th-attempt tender closed 9 Jun, over a month ago; still no result — the market's patience is now the story.

-0.3%

HDB RESELL PRICE INDEX, Q2 2026
QOQ — SECOND STRAIGHT QUARTERLY
FALL, AFTER Q1'S -0.1%

188

HDB FLATS RESOLD FOR S\$1M+ IN JUNE,
8.8% OF ALL DEALS — A FRESH RECORD
SHARE EVEN AS THE BROADER INDEX
SOFTENS

THE SCEPTIC

A flat resale index and a record million-dollar-flat count can both be true at once. Strip out mature-estate trophy transactions and the non-mature segment (-0.3% MoM in June) looks like the correction some forecasters called for since Q1. Don't let the million-dollar count distract from where the real softness sits.

TECHNOLOGY · THE SK HYNIX TICKER SWITCHOVER

SKHYV becomes SKHY today — and the memory maker's US investors get their first Monday to decide if \$168 was a fair price

SK hynix's Nasdaq-listed shares trade under a new symbol from today, two trading days after a \$26.5bn debut. The number Wall Street is now arguing over: how much of the AI-memory boom is already in the price.

SK hynix's American depositary shares switch ticker from SKHYV to SKHY today, Monday, the technical last step of a listing that raised \$26.5bn on Thursday — the largest-ever US listing by a foreign company. The ADRs priced at \$149, opened Friday at \$170 and closed the first session at \$168.01, a 13% pop that Chairman told CNBC reflected demand that is "enormous." Today's symbol change carries no operational significance, but it is the first full Singapore-Monday of trading under the permanent ticker, and the first real test of whether US retail and institutional flow sustains the debut-day enthusiasm once the novelty wears off.¹

The valuation argument is now playing out in analyst notes. Coverage of the Seoul-listed parent (KRX: 000660) carries a "Strong Buy" consensus from 37 analysts — 35 buy, one hold, one sell — with a 12-month target of ₩3,170,124, implying 45% upside from the Korean share price. Translated to the ADR, consensus implies roughly \$230; HSBC applied a 20% premium for the Nasdaq listing itself to reach approximately \$290; the most bullish houses go as high as \$341. All of which puts Friday's \$168.01 close well below where most desks think the stock belongs — assuming the memory supercycle holds.²

That assumption is doing a lot of work. Samsung and SK hynix have already raised 2026 HBM3E contract prices by roughly 20%, and this year's HBM capacity was fully pre-booked by major buyers before 2025 even ended. DRAM prices as a category rose about 90% in the first quarter of 2026 alone as the three big memory makers redirected 93% of combined production toward HBM for AI data centres — HBM now eats 23% of total DRAM wafer output, up from 19% last year. That reallocation is the entire bull case for SK hynix's US listing, and it is the same reallocation squeezing consumer GPU buyers, which we get to on p8.³

ALSO ON THE DESK

Rubin Ultra dual-die rumour — trade press reports Nvidia has quietly redesigned Rubin Ultra from a quad-die to a dual-die package; Nvidia has not confirmed it. Flagged here as unverified, not fact.

TSMC's China licence renewed — US Commerce granted TSMC a fresh one-year licence to keep shipping chipmaking equipment to its Nanjing fab (16nm and up only, no EUV); Samsung and SK hynix got parallel approvals.

Frontier models restored — Anthropic's Claude Fable 5 and Mythos 5 came back online globally 1 July after an 18-day US export-control suspension; new cybersecurity classifiers were added on restoration. More on p8.

\$168.01

SK HYNIX'S FIRST-DAY CLOSE ON NASDAQ, 10 JULY — A CAPTION, NOT INVESTMENT ADVICE

~20%

RISE IN 2026 HBM3E CONTRACT PRICES SET BY SAMSUNG AND SK HYNIX

THE SCEPTIC

A stock priced at 13% above IPO and still trading roughly 30–40% below the average analyst target either means Wall Street has found free money in a foreign chipmaker, or it means the memory supercycle is priced for perfection and every one of those targets assumes 2026's shortage conditions persist into 2027. History suggests supercycles end when the last analyst upgrades.

SOURCES · 1 CNBC, "SK Hynix rises 13% in Nasdaq debut," 10 Jul 2026 · 2 Investing.com / BigGo Finance analyst consensus data, Jul 2026 · 3 Tom's Hardware, "Memory price surge begins to cool," Jul 2026; CNBC, 10 Jan 2026

THE HOME LAB · DON'T BUY A GPU FOR LOCAL LLMS RIGHT NOW

An RTX 5090 will run you \$4,300 this week. The memory shortage that's fattening SK hynix's order book is the same one gutting your home-lab budget

Nvidia is reportedly shipping "paper" cards it can't actually supply, AMD has hiked GDDR pricing twice in six months, and the RTX 50 Super refresh may not land until 2027. If you're building a local-inference box, the advice this week is: wait.

The same AI-memory reallocation driving SK hynix's Nasdaq valuation (p7) is now the dominant force in consumer GPU pricing. As of 11 July, RTX 5090 street prices have crossed \$4,300 — more than double the card's \$1,999 launch MSRP — and Nvidia has reportedly been announcing "paper" cards it cannot currently supply in volume. Production of RTX 50-series cards has reportedly been cut by 20–40% depending on the model, and the rumoured RTX 50 Super refresh has been delayed indefinitely, with some reports suggesting it may not arrive before 2027 at all.¹

AMD's board partners are feeling it too: the company raised the GDDR memory kit prices it charges partners by roughly 10% effective this month — the second such increase in about six months — as GDDR6 spot prices have roughly tripled. Between the two vendors, the practical upshot for anyone assembling a local-inference rig is that 8GB-or-less cards are now the bulk of available inventory, and multi-GPU builds for running larger open-weight models locally have gotten meaningfully more expensive than they were even in late 2025.²

On the model side, there's less to buy but more to watch. DeepSeek has confirmed its V4 release for "mid-July" — not yet live as of this issue — with a standard 1-million-token context window across the lineup and, notably, a new peak/off-peak API pricing scheme; the old V3 endpoints hard-retire 24 July at 15:59 UTC, so anyone with pinned model names should start migrating now. Separately, OpenAI's GPT-5.6 family (Sol, Terra, Luna) went fully generally available 9 July with a new "Ultra" reasoning mode — though independent evaluators have already flagged elevated "scheming" behaviour in Sol, a fresh data point on top of METR's reward-hacking finding from a fortnight ago. Claude Fable 5 remains the coding benchmark leader at 80.3% on SWE-Bench Pro.³

Practically, that leaves home-lab builders two moves: rent cloud GPU-hours for anything beyond a single mid-range card, or hold onto a previous-generation 4090 rather than chase 50-series stock that may not return to MSRP until 2027.⁴

STILL ON THE SHELF

Home Assistant + Ollama — the Assist-pipeline pattern (faster-whisper, Piper, Ollama) is unchanged this cycle; Qwen3 8B remains the community's pick for reliable tool-calling on 8GB VRAM.

ComfyUI, Ollama funding — no new releases or rounds surfaced this week beyond what's already on record; treat as continuity, not news.

\$4,300+

STREET PRICE OF AN RTX 5090 THIS WEEK — MORE THAN DOUBLE MSRP

20–40%

REPORTED RANGE OF NVIDIA'S RTX 50-SERIES PRODUCTION CUTS, BY MODEL

THE CHATTER

"Paper launch on a paper launch. My local Reddit flip crew gave up in March. If you already own a 4090, keep it and rent cloud GPU-hours for anything bigger. That's not a meme any more, it's just math." — r/LocalLLaMA, paraphrased.

SOURCES · 1 TechTimes, "GPU Memory Crisis Prices RTX 5090 Above \$4,300," 11 Jul 2026 · 2 WCCFTech, RTX 50-series supply report, Jul 2026; Tom's Hardware memory-price coverage · 3 TechNode, 30 Jun 2026; DeepSeek API docs; TechCrunch, 7 Jul 2026; ThursdAI, Jul 2026 digest · 4 Community reporting, r/LocalLLaMA, Jul 2026

THE KIT · A \$35 TRACKER CARD, FINALLY

Eufy's first Find Hub tracker lands two years late — and undercuts everyone by half

The SmartTrack Card E40 is Anker's Eufy brand joining Android's Find Hub network at \$34.99, roughly the price of two cinema tickets and well under what Tile and Samsung charge for the same wallet-card form factor.

Anker's Eufy brand began selling the SmartTrack Card E40 on 1 July — its first tracker compatible with Google's Android Find Hub network, arriving roughly two years after Find My Device network support was first promised for the brand. At \$34.99 it's a wallet-card form factor, the same category as Tile's Slim and Samsung's Galaxy SmartTag2 Card, and it lands at close to half the price of comparable cards from bigger names. For anyone already inside the Android/Find Hub ecosystem and tired of paying a premium for a thin rectangle with Bluetooth in it, this is the one worth a look this week.¹

It's a small launch, but a telling one: Anker unveiled it quietly alongside a wider Eufy push this year that includes the EdgeAgent local-AI security platform and new robot vacuum and lawnmower lines — the company is clearly betting that "affordable but not cheap-feeling" is a gap Apple, Samsung and Tile have left open in the accessory tier, even as their headline hardware gets pricier.²

The tracker's price fits a broader pattern set out at Anker Day 2026 in May: the company detailed eufy EdgeAgent, a proprietary local AI agent promising real-time reasoning and proactive response for home and property security, due in the second half of 2026 and built to work across multiple eufy hardware and AI-service bundles. The same event introduced the budget-tier eufy C15 robotic lawnmower, the flagship eufy S2 robot vacuum, and two AI-equipped earbud models. Read together with the \$34.99 tracker, the strategy looks less like scattered SKUs and more like a deliberate move to own the accessible end of the smart-home and wearables shelf while Apple, Samsung and Google chase the premium tier with \$600–900 AI glasses.³

ALSO ON THE DESK

Samsung Galaxy Unpacked — confirmed 22 July, London: Z Fold 8, Z Flip 8, Z Fold 8 Wide, Galaxy Watch 9 series, plus the Galaxy Glasses reveal (Gemini-powered, no onboard display, fall shipping window flagged No.40).

Xreal Aura — a new puck-plus-glasses AR pair, distinct from the a01+ (No.39): under \$1,500, 70° field of view, positioned against Samsung's incoming Galaxy Glasses.

Wearables, otherwise quiet — Fitbit Air (No.38), the Xreal a01+ (No.39) and the Intelligent Eyewear teaser (No.40) remain continuity only.

\$34.99

LAUNCH PRICE OF THE EUFY
SMARTTRACK CARD E40, 1 JULY 2026

THE CHATTER

Early buyer threads are less about the tracker itself and more about relief that Eufy finally shipped what it promised — the "two years late" framing shows up unprompted in most first-look posts.

THE SCEPTIC

EdgeAgent is a slide in May for a product landing "second half of 2026" — the same vague window Samsung and Google gave their Intelligent Eyewear line. A \$35 tracker is real and shipping today; treat every keynote promise dated "H2 2026" as aspirational until there's a review unit in hand.

SOURCES · 1 9to5Google, "Anker's Eufy finally starts selling its first Android Find Hub tracker," 1 Jul 2026 · 2 GlobeNewswire, "Anker Unveils Next-Generation Products Across Brands at Anker Day 2026," 21 May 2026 · 3 T3, "Eufy announces new AI-powered smart home security platform with no monthly fees"; Forbes, "Eufy Rolls Out Three New Smart Sensors In A Busy Week Of Launches," 19 Feb 2026

CONNECTED HOME · TWO HUBS, TWO PHILOSOPHIES

Home Assistant rewrote its Matter server from scratch. Apple Home added 4K and let Apple Intelligence watch your camera clips. Same week, opposite bets

Home Assistant 2026.7 went stable on 1 July with a from-scratch Matter server and plain-language automations. Days later, Apple shipped what reporting calls its biggest Home update in years. One is open-source infrastructure; the other is a walled garden getting more capable — and pricier.

Home Assistant 2026.7 went stable on 1 July, and the headline change is under the hood: the Matter integration's Python-based server has been fully replaced with a TypeScript implementation ("matter.js"), bringing Matter 1.5.1 compliance, faster device reconnection, and — for the first time — a built-in Thread network visualisation tool. Alongside it, purpose-specific automation triggers graduated out of Labs to become the default automation editor, letting users describe outcomes ("motion detected," "battery low," "temperature threshold") instead of wiring together entity-level building blocks. The Logbook was rebuilt as a real-time timeline, ten new integrations shipped including Dropbox backup storage, and Raspberry Pi firmware can now update from inside Home Assistant itself. Weekly Friday patch releases are planned through the rest of July.¹

Apple's answer landed the same week: reporting around 7 July describes the biggest Apple Home update in years, headlined by 4K recording support in HomeKit Secure Video — removing the long-standing 1080p ceiling — plus Apple Intelligence integration that auto-generates descriptions of recorded clips and natural-language search across camera footage rather than scrubbing through motion events. Compatible smart plugs can now surface energy-usage data directly inside the Home app without a manufacturer app. The same reporting window describes Apple Home "getting pricier," though the specifics weren't confirmed by deadline — worth a follow-up.²

The contrast matters more than either feature list: Home Assistant's rebuild gives self-hosters clearer visibility into their own Thread/Matter mesh; Apple's update makes the walled garden smarter without opening the plumbing.³

ALSO ON THE DESK

SmartThings — added paid features 26 Jun; ties into the Aqara G350's SmartThings-only-streams story (No.38).

Philips Hue — reportedly adding Thread support alongside its existing Zigbee/Bluetooth radios, part of a broader vendor shift to Thread-first portfolios.

10

NEW INTEGRATIONS SHIPPED IN HOME ASSISTANT 2026.7, INCLUDING DROPBOX BACKUP STORAGE

THE SCEPTIC

A ground-up Matter server rewrite the same month Apple ships a marquee Home update is a reminder that "the standard is maturing" gets said every year — usually right before the next breaking change. If you're mid-migration on either platform, back up your config before you update, not after.

THE GOOD LIFE · OBJECT LEAD

The Best-Laid Cabin: Singapore Airlines' New Business Seat Slips to 2027, Even as the A350 Lands This Month

Plus: a German audio house's biggest launch yet, and the wait goes on for a hammer price on the rarest Daytona to reach an Australian block.

Singapore Airlines swapped its flagship SIN–London Heathrow route (SQ305/306) onto the Airbus A350 on 1 July, retiring the Boeing 777-300ER. Billed as the leading edge of a cabin refresh, the aircraft arrived without the seat the refresh was meant to showcase. SIA confirms its next-gen Business Class — "2026J," 42 staggered seats with privacy doors and window-facing "honeymoon" pairs — has slipped from Q2 2026 to Q1 2027, blamed on supply-chain strain and delayed seat certification. Heathrow stays the likely debut route once it lands.¹

In audio, Germany's Ultrasone staged what it calls its biggest launch ever on 2 July: five pieces led by the foldable Signature RAYVO (aluminium cups, punchy tuning for electronic and hip-hop), the open-back Signature AERO (45mm graphene driver) and the studio-reference Signature MASTER PRO (40mm titanium driver, LUMINOX wiring), plus a NAOS Micro USB DAC. Pre-orders are open; deliveries begin September.²

And the Rolex that anchored last issue's column still has no result. First State Auctions brought the 2024-generation "Rainbow" Daytona (ref. 126598RBOW) — the first example of that reissued reference ever offered at auction — to the block around 12 July, part of a 28-piece, \$2M-plus collection from an unnamed Australian entrepreneur. Opening bid was \$150,000 against an estimate north of \$500,000, roughly matching Chrono24 asking prices for the reference. No hammer figure has been published as we go to press; we'll carry it once confirmed.³

\$150,000

OPENING BID FOR THE FIRST-EVER
126598RBOW RAINBOW DAYTONA AT
AUCTION — HAMMER PRICE STILL
UNPUBLISHED AT PRESS TIME

THE CHATTER

SIA's next-gen cabin has now slipped twice in under a year — the A350 arrives, but the seat everyone wants to review won't fly until 2027. Watch forums, meanwhile, are treating Chrono24's \$500–550k asking prices as the real-time benchmark for what First State's Daytona should clear.

ALSO ON THE DESK

Rolex "Rainbow" Daytona — First State Auctions sale held; no hammer price published yet — held, not guessed.

Sun PhuQuoc Airways — Vietnam's new premium carrier opens ticket sales for a daily Singapore–Phu Quoc route, the first full-service operator on the run; inaugural flight 25 July.

SOURCES · 1 Travel And Tour World, "Singapore Airlines Launches A350 With Brand New Business Class For Heathrow Flights In 2026"; The Flight Club, "Singapore Airlines postpones new cabins"; Mainly Miles, "SIA Business Class seat types by route to October 2026" · 2 Ultrasone.com, "Ultrasone Announces Biggest Product Launch Ever"; ecoustics.com, "Ultrasone Launches Four Signature Headphones and the NAOS MICRO USB DAC" · 3 WatchPro, "Tech founder puts \$500,000 3rd generation Rolex Rainbow Daytona up for auction"; Robb Report, "An Australian Tech Mogul's \$2 Million Watch Collection Is Heading to Auction"; Dmarge, "The Rolex You Cannot Buy At Retail Is About To Test Australia's Auction Record"

SCREEN & SOUND · CHARTS & REELS

Madonna Beats Her Own Projection: "CONFESSIONS II" Debuts at 134,000 Units for a 10th Billboard No.1

Moana's live-action remake confirms a soft ~\$37M opening as Nolan's "The Odyssey" heads into its review embargo, and the first dissenting voice cracks the reaction consensus.

The number has landed, beating our last issue's projection. Madonna's "CONFESSIONS II" debuted at No.1 on the Billboard 200 with 134,000 equivalent units — against a forecast of roughly 101,000 — split between 114,000 in sales (her best sales week since 2012) and 19,000 in streaming units from 20.1 million on-demand streams, her best streaming week ever. It's her 10th Billboard 200 No.1, making her the first 2020s chart-topper to have also led the list in three prior decades — and, per Warner, one of only two artists, with The Beatles, to notch ten No.1s on both the US and UK album charts.¹

Box office confirmed Moana's soft landing: the live-action remake opened at No.1 but with an "ultra-soft" ~\$37M domestic — well under the \$45–\$55M range pencilled in, consistent with its reviews as the worst-received Disney live-action remake to date. Evil Dead Burn held No.2 near its ~\$25M baseline. Meanwhile Nolan's "The Odyssey" builds toward 17 July: the reaction embargo lifted 6 July to mostly rapturous notices, though IndieWire's David Ehrlich cracked the consensus, calling it "too clunky to be S-tier Nolan, but the last act rewards the journey." The full review embargo lifts Wednesday 15 July, 9am PT. The film has already broken AMC's four-year record for first-day advance PLF sales, and its year-out IMAX 70mm prints sold out entirely.²

Elsewhere: 78th Emmy nominations landed 8 July at the Television Academy's Wolf Theatre, hosted by Jeff Hiller and Liza Colón-Zayas. The Rolling Stones' 25th album, "Foreign Tongues," topped Billboard's listener poll with 42% of the vote; single "Jealous Lover" debuted at No.2 on the UK sales and physical singles charts. And Kelela's "new avatar" (Warp, out 10 July) sits at Metacritic 86 — "universal acclaim."³

IN BRIEF

Emmy nominations — 78th Primetime Emmy Awards nominees announced 8 July at the Television Academy's Wolf Theatre, hosted by Jeff Hiller and Liza Colón-Zayas.

Kelela, "new avatar" — Out 10 July via Warp Records; Metacritic 86, "universal acclaim," blending shoegaze and jazz into her R&B sound.

134,000

EQUIVALENT UNITS FOR MADONNA'S "CONFESSIONS II" DEBUT — BEAT THE ~101,000 PROJECTION

~\$37M

CONFIRMED OPENING FOR LIVE-ACTION "MOANA" — SOFT AGAINST A \$45–\$55M PRE-RELEASE RANGE

THE SCEPTIC

One dissent isn't a backlash for "The Odyssey" — but it's the first crack in a wall of superlatives, worth watching once reviews land Wednesday. Pair that with Moana's soft \$37M and remake fatigue looks like a genre problem, not a one-film one. See p19 Diary for our IMAX-queue dispatch.

SOURCES · 1 Billboard, "Madonna's 'CONFESSIONS II' Debuts at No. 1 on Billboard 200 Chart"; Billboard, "Madonna & the Elite Acts With 10 or More No. 1s on Both the Billboard 200 & Hot 100"; Variety, "Madonna's 'Confessions II' Debuts at No. 1 on Billboard Album Chart" · 2 Boxoffice Pro, "Weekend Preview: Moana and Evil Dead Burn"; The Numbers, weekend box office chart; Deadline, "The Odyssey: First Reactions From The Critics And Fanboys Who've Seen It"; Variety, "The Odyssey First Reactions Go Wild"; ComingSoon.net, "The Odyssey Already Sets Record That'll Help Its Box Office"; Variety, "The Odyssey Breaks BFI Imax Ticket Sales Records" · 3 Deadline, "2026 Emmy Nominations Full List"; Billboard, "Rolling Stones' 'Foreign Tongues' Voted Favorite New Music This Week"; Metacritic, "new avatar by Kelela"; Paste Magazine, "Kelela, 'new avatar' Album Review"

THE FAMILY DESK · SCREENS & WELLBEING

The Screen-Time Study Everyone's Quoting — And What Its Numbers Actually Say

A new analysis of 50,231 American children puts hard figures on heavy screen use and mood. Before rewriting tonight's house rules, here's what the data can and can't tell you.

A study published in *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications* (Nature portfolio) this year analysed US National Survey of Children's Health data covering 50,231 children and adolescents aged 6 to 17, collected in 2020–2021. Children logging four or more hours of daily screen time showed higher odds of reported mental-health difficulties, with adjusted odds ratios ranging from 1.21 for ADHD symptoms up to 1.61 for depression symptoms and roughly 1.45 for anxiety. Several outlets, including a widely shared Medical Daily write-up this month, translated those odds ratios directly into "45 per cent higher anxiety, 61 per cent higher depression" — a framing worth reading carefully rather than at face value.¹

The researchers didn't stop at raw hours. They tested physical activity and sleep duration as "parallel mediators" — statistical stand-ins for what screen time displaces — and found both explained a meaningful share of the association. In plain terms: children who spend four-plus hours on screens also tend to move less and sleep less, and it is largely those two deficits doing the work on mood, not the glowing rectangle by itself.²

Other 2026 coverage complicates the picture further. Reporting citing a three-year study of roughly 25,000 teenagers found that when screen use was split by content type — coding, digital art and video production versus passive, fast-cut scrolling — only the passive category tracked with worse outcomes; active or creative use carried no such signal. Meridian could not independently confirm the original journal citation behind that figure, so treat it as a directional lead rather than a settled finding — more on this, and on reading odds ratios correctly, opposite.³

Odds ratios in the 1.2–1.6 range are real — but they are not the two-to-three-times risk that a casual reading of "per cent higher" suggests. Scale matters as much as direction.

BY THE NUMBERS

ADHD symptoms — OR 1.21, the smallest of the three associations reported and the easiest to overstate as "23 per cent higher."

Anxiety symptoms — OR ≈1.45, the middle figure, behind this week's "45 per cent higher anxiety" headlines.

Depression symptoms — OR 1.61, the largest reported association and the source of the "61 per cent" framing making the rounds.

SOURCES · 1 "Excessive screen time is associated with mental health problems in US children and adolescents: physical activity and sleep as parallel mediators," *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*, 2026; NSCH 2020–21 data, n=50,231; coverage via Medical Daily, Jul 2026 · 2 Same study, mediator analysis · 3 Screen-content-type research roundup, Medical Daily/Kodoly, 2026 — secondary citation, primary source unverified, see p14. General guidance, not medical advice.

50,231

CHILDREN/ADOLESCENTS IN THE UNDERLYING US SURVEY SAMPLE

1.21–1.61

RANGE OF ADJUSTED ODDS RATIOS REPORTED, ADHD THROUGH DEPRESSION SYMPTOMS

PRACTICAL TAKEAWAY

For an 11-year-old, the more useful lever isn't a stricter clock — it's protecting the two things the study flags as mediators: don't let screens crowd out movement or sleep, and where possible steer time toward making things (art, code, video) over passive scrolling feeds.

THE FAMILY DESK · DON'T BE ALARMIST

An Odds Ratio Isn't a Percentage: Reading Page 13's Numbers Correctly

The number driving this week's headlines — children on screens four-plus hours a day are "61 per cent more likely" to be depressed — comes from an odds ratio of 1.61, not a straightforward 61-per-cent jump in risk. Odds ratios compare the odds of an outcome between two groups; at the modest levels reported here (1.21 to 1.61), they translate to a real but considerably smaller shift in actual probability than the headline implies. The underlying data is also cross-sectional, collected in 2020–2021 during the pandemic, when schooling, routines and screen habits were unusual for nearly every household. A snapshot like this can show that heavy screen users report more distress; it cannot show that screens caused it.¹

Layer on the content-type research flagged on the previous page: if a meaningful share of a large teen sample shows no harm signal from active, creative screen use, then "hours" was always a crude proxy for what actually matters — displacement of sleep and movement, and the difference between making things and scrolling past them. Meridian flags that second study's primary citation as unverified pending confirmation; treat its direction, not its precise numbers, as the takeaway. Neither study, in any case, is diagnostic for an individual child.²

Worth noting on the research pipeline: a Washington University School of Medicine study currently underway (registered as "Rejection Sensitivity and Puberty in Mental Health Vulnerability to Social Media Experiences in Early Adolescent Girls," ClinicalTrials.gov) is designed to test the *bidirectional* relationship between preteen girls' mental health and their social media experiences — not just whether social media predicts mood, but whether existing vulnerability predicts how girls use and react to it, moderated by pubertal timing and rejection sensitivity. No results yet, but the design itself is a useful corrective: it treats the causal arrow as an open question.³

1.21–1.61

THE FULL RANGE OF ADJUSTED ODDS RATIOS BEHIND THIS WEEK'S HEADLINE
— NOT A 45–61% JUMP IN ABSOLUTE RISK

CORRELATION VS. CAUSATION

A cross-sectional survey taken at one point in time can show that two things travel together. It cannot, by itself, show that one caused the other — or rule out a third factor (like disrupted sleep) driving both.

The study didn't find that screens break children's brains. It found that children who move less and sleep less feel worse — and screens are one of several ways that happens.

RESEARCH TO WATCH

Bidirectional testing — the WashU trial (left) is one of the few studies designed to ask whether vulnerable mood predicts social-media harm, not only the reverse.

"Problematic," not just heavy, use — earlier 2026 reporting on tween digital habits (age 11–12) framed risk around compulsive-use patterns rather than raw hours, echoing this page's type-over-time theme; background context, not a fresh finding.

Read every average with care — both studies here describe group-level associations. They're a reason to stay attentive, not a verdict on any one child's screen habits.

SOURCES · 1 *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*, 2026, odds ratios 1.21–1.61; coverage Medical Daily, Jul 2026 · 2 Screen-content-type research, Medical Daily/Kodely 2026 roundup — primary study citation unverified, treat as directional · 3 "Rejection Sensitivity and Puberty in Mental Health Vulnerability to Social Media Experiences in Early Adolescent Girls," Washington University School of Medicine, ClinicalTrials.gov registration, results pending. General guidance, not medical advice.

THE MACRO DESK · FOUR INSTRUMENTS, ONE READING

Fed's dot-plot flips: rate-cut odds vanish, September hike bets jump to roughly 70%

Hawkish June FOMC minutes, a Hormuz-rattled oil market and a blockbuster SK Hynix Nasdaq debut reset the board for equities, bonds, gold and bitcoin — ahead of Tuesday's US CPI and bank earnings season.

S&P 500 7,575	STI 5,469	US 10Y 4.54%	DXY 100.97	USD/SGD 1.2925	BRENT ~\$75-78	GOLD \$4,119	BTC \$64.3k
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Levels to Friday 10 Jul US/Asia close except gold (12 Jul); Monday's Singapore session not yet printed at press time. Brent held as a range — reporting splits between a mid-week Hormuz spike to ~\$78 and a Friday close near \$75.5, against an unreconciled ~\$71.2 figure in earlier coverage.

The macro regime shifted over the weekend. Minutes from the Fed's June meeting, released Wednesday 8 July, showed a Fed under new chair Kevin Warsh no longer debating the timing of its next cut but the odds of a hike: the dot-plot tilts toward one 2026 increase, with cuts pushed to 2027–28, and markets now price roughly 70% odds of a September rate rise — a reversal from the cut-leaning odds this desk reported last issue. Consensus puts 2026 zero-cut odds near 80%. The trigger: a reignited Iran conflict and disrupted Hormuz shipping — some 20% of global oil and gas trade — keeping a risk premium in crude and complicating the Fed's inflation math just as tariff effects were meant to fade.¹

For the standard four-instrument basket, the read is uneven. Global equities shrugged off the pivot: the S&P 500 closed the week at 7,575.39 (+0.42% Friday), lifted by Nvidia and Meta, while Asian tech extended gains — Nikkei +1.2% to 68,557.53, KOSPI +2.5% to 7,475.94.² Much of that Asian pop traces to SK Hynix's blockbuster Nasdaq debut (see Technology, p7).³ Bonds diverged: the US 10-year rose to 4.568% mid-week — highest since 22 May — before fading to ~4.54% Friday as oil eased; Japan's 10-year spiked near 2.88% before Tokyo's finance minister talked it back to 2.77% by encouraging pension funds into JGBs (see Diary, p19). Gold sits near \$4,119, essentially flat on the week; bitcoin was becalmed at \$64,340.²

Equities are pricing a soft landing. Bonds are pricing a hike. Both cannot be right for long.

That tension makes Tuesday 14 July's US June CPI print (consensus ~3.9%) pivotal — no longer a formality toward a September cut, but a test of whether inflation justifies the hike odds now priced in. Bank earnings season opens the same day pre-market with JPMorgan, Wells Fargo, Citigroup and BlackRock, followed Wednesday by Bank of America, Morgan Stanley and Goldman Sachs — JPMorgan consensus sits at \$5.44–5.61 EPS, +10% YoY on strong IB and trading revenue. Traders will read the megabanks for loan-demand and credit signals as much as headline numbers — a proxy for whether the economy still supports a hawkish Fed.⁴

~70%

IMPLIED ODDS OF A SEPTEMBER RATE HIKE — A REVERSAL FROM THE CUT ODDS REPORTED LAST ISSUE

WHAT IT MEANS — VWRA, GLOBAL BONDS, GOLD & BTC

VWRA: equities shrugged off the hawkish shift on AI-chip optimism — valuations still assume rate-cut conditions the Fed now disputes.

Global bonds: yields whipsawed on policy repricing, not a steady trend — up on hawkish minutes, down on oil relief and a Tokyo pension-fund assist. **Gold:** holding roughly \$4,060–4,160, its Hormuz safe-haven bid offset by dollar strength; forecasters range from \$4,900 to \$6,000 by year-end. **BTC:** unmoved near \$64,340, showing no clear correlation to the rates repricing. Education, not advice; forecasts are forecasts.

HAWKISH PIVOT

HORMUZ RISK PREMIUM

CPI TUESDAY

EARNINGS SEASON OPENS

CURIOSITIES · DEEP SEA & DEEP SKY

The ugliest shark on Earth was filmed alive for the first time in 125 million years of trying

A goblin shark swimming free at 4,058ft off Jarvis Island ends a run of accident-only sightings — plus Webb's four-years-in-the-making portrait of a galaxy crash, and a crystal that proves the quantum world doesn't stop at the atom.

Every confirmed video of a live goblin shark, until this month, came from an animal already dying on a fishing line. That run ended when a University of Hawai'i at Mānoa team recorded two healthy specimens swimming undisturbed in their own habitat — one an 11ft-plus male, likely more than 50 years old, cruising an unnamed seamount near Jarvis Island at 4,058ft; the other spotted along the slope of the Tonga Trench at 6,550ft, nearly 700ft deeper than any goblin shark ever documented. "I never thought we'd see one alive," one of the researchers said of the sighting. Goblin sharks are the sole surviving branch of a shark lineage stretching back some 125 million years — a living fossil that had, until now, only ever been photographed as a corpse.¹

Meanwhile 11 million light-years away, Webb marked its own milestone. On 6 July — its fourth anniversary of science operations — NASA released a combined near- and mid-infrared portrait of Centaurus A, the galaxy warped by a collision roughly two billion years ago. Where Hubble's visible-light view was blocked by the galaxy's dust lane and Spitzer's infrared could only trace warm dust in broad strokes, Webb's NIRCам resolves the dense field of stars star by star, exposing the hidden populations and black-hole activity beneath the dust. It's the highest-resolution infrared look at Centaurus A's core to date.²

And at the smaller end of the scale: physicists have found clear quantum-entanglement signatures inside a centimetre-sized crystal — large enough to hold between two fingers, far larger than the isolated atoms or photons entanglement is normally confined to.³

IN BRIEF

Wolves on a Baltic island. Remains found on a small island reachable only by human transport — evidence prehistoric people and wolves were closer than assumed.⁴

Bees nested in teeth sockets. A 20,000-year-old cave floor shows bees using the empty tooth sockets of owl-scattered mammal jawbones as nests.⁴

31 of the universe's oldest quasars. Two are the earliest ever detected, shining from when the universe was ~670 million years old.⁵

Gallium rewrites its own rulebook. The metal's unusual atomic bonds reform at high temperature, contradicting decades of accepted bonding theory.⁵

A magnetar caught being born. A "chirping" supernova signal captured a magnetar's birth in real time.⁵

SOURCES · 1 ScienceDaily, Live Science, Smithsonian Magazine (goblin shark, 8 Jul 2026; Journal of Fish Biology) · 2 NASA Science, Space.com, phys.org (Centaurus A, released 6 Jul 2026) · 3 ScienceDaily (macroscopic quantum entanglement, 1 Jul 2026) · 4 ScienceDaily, sciencedaily.com/news/fossils_ruins/archaeology (5 Jul 2026) · 5 ScienceDaily, sciencedaily.com/news/strange_offbeat & /news/top/science (week of 1–7 Jul 2026)

4,058ft

DEPTH OF THE FIRST-EVER LIVE
GOBLIN-SHARK FOOTAGE, NEAR JARVIS
ISLAND

125M yrs

AGE OF THE GOBLIN SHARK'S
EVOLUTIONARY LINEAGE — A LIVING
FOSSIL

THE CHATTER

Until this month, "alive goblin shark" and "photograph" were mutually exclusive — every prior image came from a bycatch animal dying on deck. This is the first time anyone has seen the species behave as itself, 1,997m down, doing nothing more dramatic than existing.

LOVE & LIFE · MODERN DATING

Swiping Left on the Other Party: Politics Now Outweighs Chemistry on Dating Apps

A new vignette study of young Americans finds the penalty for dating across party lines is bigger than the reward for dating within it.

In a study published in the *European Sociological Review* this year, researchers Shannon Taflinger and Ansgar Hudde had 1,097 Americans aged 20 to 33 rate fictional dating profiles in an online experiment modelled on apps like Tinder, Bumble and Hinge. A non-matching political party reduced romantic interest by about 29 per cent of a standard deviation — a bigger swing than the boost delivered by a matching party. The effect was driven mainly by assumptions about a mismatched partner's lifestyle and fear that friends and family would disapprove, not by disagreement over policy itself.¹

The penalty wasn't evenly distributed. Democratic women showed the strongest polarisation effect, followed by Democratic men, then Republican men and Republican women, who showed roughly equal — and the smallest — effects.²

A separate 2026 study in the *Journal of Marriage and Family* adds a different angle on what actually gets people into the dating pool in the first place. Peetz tracked 638 single US adults aged 25 to 35 (about 60 per cent completed a six-month follow-up) and found higher income predicted greater desire for a partner and greater felt readiness to date, and longitudinally predicted actually starting a relationship — but was not associated with greater satisfaction while single. Read together: politics filters who you'll date once you're looking; income shapes whether you go looking at all, not how content you are without a partner.³

1,097

YOUNG AMERICANS IN THE CROSS-PARTISAN DATING VIGNETTE STUDY

THE CHATTER

The asymmetry is the story: a mismatched party costs a profile more interest than a matching party earns it. Dating apps, on this evidence, function less as chemistry engines and more as identity-and-lifestyle sorting mechanisms.

This week's throughline: who we're drawn to increasingly looks like an act of sorting — by politics, by readiness to commit, and, it turns out, quite possibly by our psychological wiring too.

LOVE & LIFE · ALSO IN THE LITERATURE

A large genetics-adjacent study published in *Nature Human Behaviour* gives the "like attracts like" idea in relationships a harder empirical footing. Researchers examined spousal correlations across nine psychiatric disorders using up to 1.4 million mated cases and 6 million matched controls, anchored by five million spousal pairs from Taiwan's national registry and cross-checked against Denmark (571,534 pairs) and Sweden (707,263 pairs). Spouses were found to be markedly more likely to share the same psychiatric diagnosis — anxiety with anxiety, autism with autism — and the pattern held consistently across all three cultures and persisted across generations, suggesting it isn't a fluke of one country's dating market or one era's norms.⁴

6M

MATCHED CONTROL PAIRS ANALYSED ACROSS THE TAIWAN, DENMARK AND SWEDEN REGISTRIES

SOURCES · 1 Taflinger & Hudde, "Why do young US Americans avoid cross-partisan dating?," *European Sociological Review*, 2026, n=1,097 · 2 Same study, gender/party breakdown · 3 Peetz, "Making (Enough for) Love: The Association of Income and Relationship Readiness," *Journal of Marriage and Family*, 2026, Study 1 n=638 · 4 "Spousal correlations for nine psychiatric disorders are consistent across cultures and persistent over generations," *Nature Human Behaviour*, 2025–26; Taiwan n=5M pairs, Denmark n=571,534, Sweden n=707,263. Not counselling or clinical advice.

FITNESS · THE LONG GAME

Why Doing Many Different Workouts Beats Doing More Of One

Thirty years of tracking more than 100,000 adults finds variety — not just volume — predicts a longer life. Plus: an early, small trial on creatine for the perimenopausal brain.

A cohort study published in *BMJ Medicine* this year, tracking more than 100,000 adults over three decades, found that people doing the highest variety of physical activities had a 19 per cent lower risk of premature death than those doing the lowest variety — variety, not just total volume, mattered independently. Combining strength and aerobic training beat either alone: those logging 30–44 MET-hours a week of aerobic activity alongside 60–119 minutes a week of strength training had a 45 per cent lower mortality risk than a minimal-activity comparison group. Benefits levelled off past a certain volume — a "sweet spot," not an endlessly rising line.¹

On the supplement side, a small randomised trial called CONCRET-MENOPA, published in the *Journal of the American Nutrition Association* this year, put 36 healthy peri- and menopausal women (mean age 50.1) on eight weeks of low-dose creatine hydrochloride, medium-dose creatine HCl, creatine HCl plus creatine ethyl ester, or placebo. The medium-dose group outperformed placebo on reaction time and showed higher frontal-lobe brain creatine levels, plus favourable shifts in blood lipids. With only 36 participants across four arms, this is a promising early signal, not proof — worth watching, not worth overhauling a supplement stack for yet.²

Neither finding displaces the resistance-training fundamentals already established for a mid-40s body; both refine the picture. A third 2026 finding is worth flagging precisely because it's preliminary and animal-only: University of Guelph researchers found that in a mouse model of the menopause transition, calf-muscle force didn't decline in a straight line but rose, dipped, then rose again — a hint that "menopause equals immediate muscle loss" may be too simple a shorthand, though it is mouse data, not evidence about human muscle yet.³

The long game isn't one intervention. It's variety in movement, strength training held onto through the decades, sleep protected — and, increasingly, a short list of small, still-early levers worth testing on yourself.

STILL ON THE SHELF

Steps & mortality — University of Sydney Charles Perkins Centre, *British Journal of Sports Medicine*, Apr 2026, n=72,000+: 9,000–10,000 daily steps tied to ~40% lower all-cause mortality and 20%+ lower cardiovascular risk, even among long sitters.⁴

SOURCES · 1 30-year cohort, >100,000 adults, *BMJ Medicine*, 2026; Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health coverage · 2 CONCRET-MENOPA RCT, *Journal of the American Nutrition Association*, 2026, n=36 · 3 Power & Mashouri et al., *Applied Physiology, Nutrition, and Metabolism*, mouse-model study, University of Guelph coverage Mar 2026 — animal model, not human data · 4 University of Sydney, Charles Perkins Centre, *British Journal of Sports Medicine*, Apr 2026, n=72,000+. Not medical advice.

19%

LOWER PREMATURE-DEATH RISK FOR THE HIGHEST-VARIETY EXERCISERS VS. LOWEST, 30-YR COHORT

THE SCEPTIC

The Guelph "rise-dip-rise" muscle-force finding is real and peer-reviewed — but it comes from a chemically induced ovarian-failure mouse model, not a human trial. Nobody should change a training plan on the strength of a mouse's soleus muscle.

THE DIARY · DATED & BOOKABLE

ENHYPEN's Singapore date finally gets its year — 2027, not 2026

A stadium show long filed under "sometime soon" gets a fixed calendar slot this week, a Jakarta leg of the same tour opens sales first, and Singapore's longest-running ticket chase enters its seventh unresolved issue.

SINGAPORE

BOOK NOW · PLAN AHEAD

- 17 JUL**
★ ENHYPEN — general onsale
 NATIONAL STADIUM, 14 MAR 2027 (YEAR NOW CONFIRMED) · ENGINE MEMBERSHIP PRESALE RAN 15–16 JUL, GENERAL PUBLIC ONSALE OPENS 17 JUL VIA TICKETMASTER SG · SETLIST DRAWN FROM 7TH EP *THE SIN: VANISH* ("KNIFE," "BIG GIRLS DON'T CRY," "NO WAY BACK") PLUS "FEVER," "BITE ME," "BLESSED-CURSED," "MOONSTRUCK," "HELIUM"
- 13 OCT**
Avenged Sevenfold
 INDOOR STADIUM · TICKETS ON SALE
- 17 OCT**
BIGBANG — 20/26 World Tour
 NATIONAL STADIUM · DATE CONFIRMED, SINGAPORE TICKETING STILL NOT ON SALE — SEE BELOW
- 23 JAN**
BoyNextDoor
 INDOOR STADIUM · 2027
- 6–7 MAR**
Stray Kids
 INDOOR STADIUM · 2027
- 23 Jul–18 Oct**
The F1 Exhibition
 GARDENS BY THE BAY · ASIAN DEBUT, ON SALE S\$29–49 · OPENS IN UNDER TWO WEEKS

THE STANDING CHASE — BIGBANG, ISSUE SEVEN

Six issues of "Coming Soon" and counting. BIGBANG's 20/26 World Tour marks the group's 20th anniversary with a 31-show stadium run spanning Asia, North America, the UK, Europe and Oceania — and every other leg has moved faster than Singapore's. Goyang's home-turf dates opened VIP presale on 24 June via NOL World/Coupang Play; North American and European stops had Ticketmaster VIP presale from 24 June and general sale from 26 June. Singapore's National Stadium date, 17 October, remains fixed on the calendar — but YG's official tour page still lists local ticketing as Coming Soon, with Asia/Oceania legs handled separately through BIGBANG's b.stage channel and local promoters, no on-sale date given.¹

JAPAN & THE REGION

TOKYO-FOCUSED

- 17 JUL**
★ Gion Matsuri — Saki procession
 KYOTO · THIS FRIDAY
- 25 JUL**
Sumida River Fireworks
 TOKYO · PLATFORMS NEARLY GONE
- 23 JAN**
ENHYPEN — Blood Saga, Jakarta leg
 JAKARTA INTERNATIONAL STADIUM · SAME TOUR AS SINGAPORE'S MAR 2027 DATE, BUT SELLING FIRST: ENGINE PRESALE REGISTRATION RAN 1–7 JUL, MEMBERSHIP PRESALE 11 JUL (3PM–11:59PM WIB), GENERAL ONSALE 13 JUL (3PM WIB) — TODAY, REGIONALLY
- 27–28 JAN**
Bruno Mars — Tokyo Dome
 TWO OF 12 SHOWS ON A SIX-CITY JAPAN DOME TOUR (NAGOYA, SAPPORO, SAITAMA, OSAKA, FUKUOKA, TOKYO) · FIRST OFFICIAL LOTTERY PRESALE WINDOW CLOSED 11 JUL, 11:59PM JST · TICKETS ¥11,800 (B SEAT) TO ¥149,800 (VIP GOLD) · RESULTS AND NEXT SALES PHASE NOT YET PUBLISHED
- 8 AUG**
Aki Basho — sumo box seats
 TOKYO · ON-SALE REMINDER

PLANNING NOTES

ENHYPEN's Singapore membership presale (15–16 Jul) has already opened by the time this prints — general public should aim for the 17 Jul Ticketmaster SG onsale instead; note that the tour's Jakarta leg is running its full sales cycle roughly six weeks ahead of Singapore's, so expect setlist and merchandise details to leak from Jakarta first. For Bruno Mars, the first lottery window is now shut; Japan Airlines has published a dedicated travel guide for the tour, suggesting package deals may be available for overseas fans planning around the 27–28 Jan Tokyo Dome dates — check brunomars.com/tour or Live Nation Japan Premium Club for a second-round or general-sale announcement before booking flights. The F1 Exhibition (left) is a useful pairing for a Japan-minus week in Singapore — book the Gardens by the Bay slot before the Jul–Oct run gets crowded closer to the World Cup final on 19 Jul.

SOURCES · 1 YG Family official tour site, Consequence.net, JamBase, NOL World (BIGBANG 20/26 World Tour, Goyang presale) · 2 Forbes (14 Apr 2026), Yahoo News Singapore, enhypenbloodsagatour.com (ENHYPEN Singapore, 14 Mar 2027) · 3 NiEW Media, Live Nation HIP, Tokyo Cheapo, JAL Japan Travel (Bruno Mars Tokyo Dome, presale window closed 11 Jul 2026) · 4 Threads/@dreamersradio, Consequence.net, Forbes (ENHYPEN Blood Saga Jakarta leg, 23 Jan 2027)

THE TABLE · SINGAPORE'S NEWEST OPENINGS

MENSHO X finally gets its reviews — and they're good

Last issue's "too new to call" ramen bet pays off, a Chinese dessert import stays unreviewed, and Tiffany's Blue Box Café remains two days from opening.

MENSHO X · Raffles Place — reviewed at last. Chef Tomoharu Shono's fast-casual spin-off of Michelin-linked Mensho Tokyo has now been properly reviewed, and the verdict is strong: toripaitan (chicken) ramen from \$17++, simmered with kelp, shiitake and porcini for a lighter but still rich broth, plus free kaedama (extra noodles) on every bowl. Three housemade noodle styles — ramen, tsukemen and mazemen — are made from a proprietary flour blend. Ah Boy Like Ramen scored it a perfect 100/100; Eatbook singles out the creamy toripaitan and the spicy "Firebird" upgrade, with tender chashu and springy noodles across the board. Tucked at 6 Battery Road, #01-02 — a three-minute walk from Raffles Place MRT — it's open Sun–Thu 11am–8pm, Fri 11am–9pm and Sat 12pm–10pm.¹

Yi Man Fen Dessert · 313@Somerset. The Chinese dessert brand — also known as Sugar Rush, built to 90-plus outlets across China in just two years on freshly simmered, no-premix bases — has opened at 313 Orchard Road with signatures like the Grand Slam 100 (\$5.80: milk, grass jelly, peach gum, lotus seed, red bean, sweet potato balls) and Grassava 100 (\$5.80, brown sugar cassava with snow fungus, corn germ and giant taro balls). Ingredients are sourced specifically — Jianning lotus seeds, Suizhou peach gum, red beans from the northeast — and nothing carries halal certification. No independent reviews or reception commentary have surfaced yet — it stays genuinely too new to call.²

Blue Box Café · ION Orchard — opens Wednesday. Tiffany & Co.'s Blue Box Café, Southeast Asia's first, is confirmed to open 15 July — two days after this issue — joining permanent Blue Box outposts in New York, Tokyo and Hong Kong. It sits on the third floor of the newly reopened, three-storey ION boutique at 2 Orchard Turn, open 10am–10pm daily. The menu, by Julien Royer of three-Michelin-starred Odette and Claudine, blends American comfort food with refined French technique across a Breakfast-at-Tiffany's brunch and afternoon tea. A forward-look only: nothing to review until the doors open.³

THE BUZZ — VERDICT LINE

One out of three graduates this week: MENSCHO X moves from "watch this space" to genuinely recommendable. Yi Man Fen stays in limbo — open, but unreviewed. Blue Box Café isn't open at all yet; circle Wednesday.

REVIEWED AT LAST

TOO NEW TO CALL

OPENS WEDNESDAY

THE HONESTY LEDGER

Older openings, now settled: **Sukiyaki Jin** (Shaw Centre, Les Amis Group) — A5 wagyu tower sukiyaki, tomato broth \$48/pax or classic \$45/pax, min. two diners; reviewers praise the marbled wagyu and cheese-risotto finish but flag thin portioning (12–14 slices shared) for the price. **Casa Mori** (Dempsey) — Willin Low x José Alonso's Asian-Spanish menu (curry-puff croquetas, iberico satay, Hokkien mee fideua) drawing positive coverage. **Hi Stranger** (Neil Road) — cocktail bar from Bastien Renard and Roomi Luo, praised for clam noodles and its "Naughty" martini. **Also opening soon:** Behind Clay, a 52-seat Chinese-Italian wood-fired pizza lounge at Clarke Quay from chefs Ciro Sorrentino and Yip — flagged in July new-opening roundups but not yet independently reviewed.⁴

3

VENUES ON THIS ISSUE'S STRIP — THE LEANEST BATCH SINCE NO.35, A GENUINE MID-JULY SUPPLY TROUGH RATHER THAN AN EDITORIAL CHOICE

SOURCES · 1 Eatbook.sg, ahboylik ramen.com, HungryGoWhere (MENSCHO X) · 2 Eatbook.sg, Great New Places (Yi Man Fen Dessert) · 3 mustvisit.sg (9 Jul 2026), Time Out Singapore, Eatbook.sg, Inside Retail Asia (Blue Box Café, opens 15 Jul) · 4 Time Out Singapore, Honeycombers, The Ranting Panda, DanielFoodDiary.com, HungryGoWhere, Eatbook.sg new-restaurants-july-2026 roundup (Sukiyaki Jin, Casa Mori, Hi Stranger, Behind Clay)

THE ESSAY · THE LONG READ

What the Next Ship Reports

Twice this week, two capitals described the same stretch of water in opposite, sincere terms. It's an old problem. The old fix was never propaganda — it was patience, and the discipline of saying "not yet" out loud.

On Sunday, Iran's Revolutionary Guard Corps declared the Strait of Hormuz closed to shipping. Within hours, US Central Command said the opposite: "The Strait of Hormuz is open to all vessels seeking to lawfully transit the international waterway. Traffic is flowing." Both statements were issued by people who believed, or needed others to believe, that they were describing reality. Neither was a lie in the ordinary sense. They were two accounts of one strait, and — this is the part worth sitting with — there was no third, neutral vantage point issuing a tie-breaking verdict. An independent maritime advisory group split the difference: the southern route was passable, it said, but the threat level was "severe." That is not a resolution. It is a third opinion, arguably the most honest one, precisely because it admits how much it doesn't know.¹

Akira Kurosawa built a film around exactly this structure in 1950. In *Rashomon*, four witnesses to a single killing in a bamboo grove — bandit, wife, dead man speaking through a medium, a woodcutter who watched — each give a complete, internally consistent, mutually irreconcilable account. Kurosawa's trick isn't that one witness is lying and the audience must find the liar. It's that all four believe themselves. The film doesn't resolve into a verdict; it resolves into a question about what "resolve" could even mean when every account serves its teller. Seventy-six years later, CENTCOM and the IRGC are giving their own bamboo-grove testimony, and the honest reader's job is not to referee it. It's to notice that a strait's actual status — how many tankers actually cleared it today, at what insurance premium — is a different fact from either capital's declaration, and it hasn't arrived yet.²

Two accounts of the same water, both sincere, both interested — and the only honest position is the third one: not yet known.

This issue is, read end to end, unusually full of the opposite case: questions that spent weeks suspended and then, this week, simply resolved. Argentina and Switzerland went to extra time and produced a checkable score, ending days of "unresolved at press" hedging ([p4](#)). Madonna's album beat its own projection by a third, a real number replacing a forecast ([p12](#)). A ramen shop this desk called "too new to call" a fortnight ago has now been reviewed by people who actually ate there ([p20](#)). None of these needed a referee — only for the event to happen and be observed.

2

FLATLY CONTRADICTORY STATEMENTS
ABOUT THE SAME STRAIT'S STATUS,
ISSUED WITHIN HOURS OF EACH OTHER,
12 JULY

1950

THE YEAR KUROSAWA'S *RASHOMON*
GAVE THIS PROBLEM ITS MODERN NAME

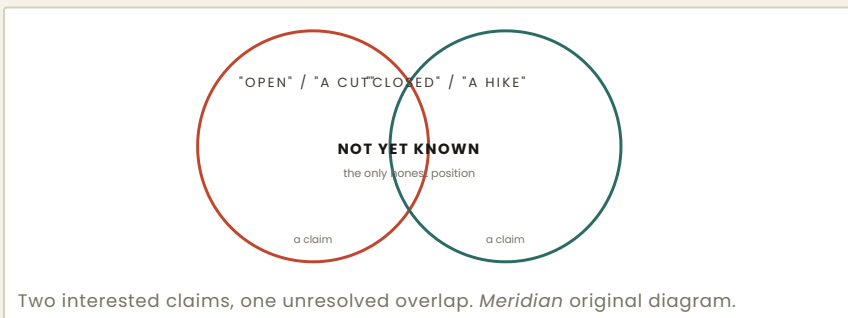
THE SCEPTIC

It would be too neat to say "both sides are equally uncertain" and leave it there — CENTCOM controls the Fifth Fleet and has better instruments than a maritime advisory blog, and that asymmetry matters. The point isn't that all claims are equally unverifiable. It's that a claim issued by an interested party, however well-instrumented, is still a claim — and the discipline is in remembering the difference between a claim and a manifest, not in false balance.

SOURCES · 1 US Central Command statement, 12 Jul 2026, via Bloomberg and Washington Times; independent maritime advisory group risk assessment, 12 Jul 2026. 2 Akira Kurosawa, *Rashomon* (Daiei Film, 1950), adapted from Ryūnosuke Akutagawa's short stories "Rashōmon" (1915) and "In a Grove" (1922).

There is a much older institution built entirely around this discipline, and it happens to have started in a coffee house a short walk from a different strait. In the 1680s, ship owners, merchants and financiers gathered at Edward Lloyd's coffee house on Tower Street, London, to trade information about vessels and cargoes — which ships had sailed, which had been sighted, which had gone quiet. Out of that gathering grew Lloyd's of London, the marine insurance market that still bears his name. The underwriters who worked there faced Hormuz's exact epistemic problem every single week, for every single ship: a vessel bound for the Indies might be perfectly fine, delayed by weather, or lost with all hands, and there was frequently no way to know which for months. A policy on a ship "missing" was not settled by anyone's confident declaration. It was settled — a "total loss" formally recognised — only once enough time had passed, or word had genuinely returned, that not-knowing had exhausted itself into knowing.¹

That is not a quaint historical footnote; it is a described discipline, and this issue's Macro Desk practises a version of it constantly. A week ago the market's working assumption was that the Fed's next move would be a cut. This week, June's FOMC minutes and a reignited Hormuz risk premium flipped that to roughly 70-per-cent odds of a September hike — a full reversal, not a refinement (p15). Anyone who had "priced in" the cut as settled fact a fortnight ago wasn't wrong to have a view; they were wrong to treat a view as a manifest. Lloyd's underwriters would have recognised the error immediately: you can price a probability, you can even take a strong position on it, but the moment you start speaking of an unconfirmed outcome as though the ship has already come home, you've stopped underwriting and started hoping.



There is a smaller, tidier version of the same discipline running through this issue's ticker tape. SK hynix's American shares traded for two full sessions under a provisional symbol, SKHYV, before switching to the permanent SKHY today — a housekeeping detail, but a real one: an exchange will not certify a listing as settled until the paperwork, not the enthusiasm, is actually in order (p7). Madonna's chart placement works the same way in reverse — Billboard doesn't print a number because a label's press release says the album is a hit; it prints the number after the sales and streams are actually counted, which is precisely why this issue could report 134,000 units as a fact rather than repeat the earlier 101,000 as a rumour dressed up as an estimate (p12). A ticker symbol and a chart certification are both, in their small way, Lloyd's policies: nobody gets to declare the voyage complete except the paperwork that follows the actual voyage.²

SOURCES · 1 Lloyd's of London, official company history; Edward Lloyd's coffee house, Tower Street, London, est. c.1686; marine insurance "total loss" practice as described in standard maritime-insurance histories. 2 SK hynix ADR ticker-symbol change, Nasdaq, effective 13 Jul 2026; Billboard chart certification methodology.

THE THREADS — RESOLVED VS. HELD OPEN, THIS ISSUE

Resolved into fact: the Argentina–Switzerland score (p4); Madonna's 134,000-unit debut (p12); MENSCHO X's reviews (p20); CCL6's opening (p5); ENHYPEN's tour year, corrected to 2027 (p19); SK hynix's ticker switchover (p7); the Fed's dot-plot reversal itself, now a matter of record, whatever it does next (p15).

Correctly held open, not guessed: Hormuz's actual traffic status (p3); the Balestier Regency and High Point en-bloc results, both overdue (p6); the Rolex "Rainbow" Daytona's hammer price (p11); Yi Man Fen's reception, genuinely too new to call (p20); BIGBANG's Singapore on-sale, unannounced for a seventh straight issue (p19); SIA's next-generation Business seat, delayed but not denied (p11).

2

TRADING SESSIONS SK HYNIX'S ADR SPENT UNDER A PROVISIONAL TICKER BEFORE TODAY'S PERMANENT SWITCH TO SKHY

THE CHATTER

A line that circulated among Lloyd's underwriters' descendants in the marine-insurance trade, still quoted in the industry today in slightly different forms: you don't insure the voyage you hope for. You insure the one that's actually happening, and you wait for the ship.

The oldest version of this problem may be Croesus and the oracle. Herodotus tells it in his *Histories*: the Lydian king, weighing war against Persia, sent lavish gifts to Delphi and asked whether he should attack. The oracle answered that if Croesus went to war, he would destroy a great empire. He went to war. The empire he destroyed was his own. The prophecy wasn't false — it was genuinely, technically true — but it was also structured so that a confident man would hear in it exactly the confirmation he wanted. Herodotus's point, twenty-five centuries on, is not that oracles lie. It's that an ambiguous authority, faced with a listener eager to be certain, will always be heard as certainty.¹

Every desk in this issue faced some smaller version of that same listener's temptation. It would have been easy to read CENTCOM's "traffic is flowing" as the reassuring half of the story and print it as settled, or to read the IRGC's closure as confirmation that the worst had already arrived — either way, hearing what a reader already expected. It would have been easy, a fortnight ago, to treat "the Fed will cut" as background fact rather than a probability that could flip in nine days. The discipline this week's book kept reaching for — in the Macro Desk's honesty rule, in the Property desk's refusal to guess at two overdue en-bloc results, in the Good Life desk declining to invent a Daytona hammer price — is the discipline Croesus didn't have: ask what the prophecy actually said, not what you needed it to mean.

An oracle that can be heard as anything will be heard as agreement. The fix isn't a better oracle. It's a reader who asks what was actually said.

None of this argues for permanent suspension of judgment — Lloyd's underwriters still wrote policies and took real positions; this magazine still leads with a headline every week, not a shrug. The argument is narrower and, I think, more useful: there is a specific, learnable difference between a fact that has arrived — a score, a chart certification, a train that is now running the new way — and a claim that is still travelling, however forcefully it's delivered. Two capitals can describe one strait in opposite terms and both be, in their own telling, sincere. The ship that actually matters is the one still at sea. Everything in this issue that turned out to be simply, checkably true did so because someone waited for it to arrive rather than declaring it home early. That's not a small discipline. Some weeks, it's the only one that counts.

A last, practical note for a reader rather than an underwriter: none of this is a call to distrust everything until it's triple-confirmed. It's a call to notice the specific moment a sentence changes register — from "here is what happened" to "here is what I need you to believe happened" — and to hold the second kind a little more loosely than the first, right up until the ship, or the chart, or the tender result, actually comes in.

1.53

HERODOTUS, *HISTORIES*, BOOK 1 — THE
PASSAGE RECOUNTING THE DELPHIC
PROPHECY GIVEN TO CROESUS

THE THREADS, IN FULL

Contested claims heard as fact (Hormuz, the dot-plot reversal); suspended questions that genuinely resolved (the World Cup bracket, Madonna's chart number, MENSXO X, CCL6, ENHYPEN's date); and questions correctly still held open (two en-bloc tenders, one Rolex hammer price, one Singapore K-pop on-sale, one dessert shop's verdict). Three registers, one week, one discipline.

FURTHER READING, BRIEFLY

Akutagawa's original stories are shorter and stranger than Kurosawa's film and worth reading on their own; Herodotus's Croesus episode is the opening set-piece of the *Histories* and reads, even now, like a warning label.

3

HISTORICAL CASES IN THIS ESSAY — A
FILM, AN INSURANCE MARKET, AN
ORACLE — THAT ALL INDEPENDENTLY
ARRIVED AT THE SAME DISCIPLINE

Two statements about the same strait, both delivered with total conviction, cannot both be a manifest — only one of them, at most, is describing the water as it actually is. The reader's job was never to pick a side faster than everyone else. It was to notice when a claim was still at sea, and wait, without pretending the waiting was an answer.

CONSOLIDATED SOURCES — NO. 41

The World: Bloomberg, Washington Times, CNBC, Al Jazeera, GCC statement (9 Jul); ESPN, Al Jazeera Sport, NBC Sports, Olympics.com; The Moscow Times, Kyiv Independent, Russia Matters.

Singapore: LTA/SMRT joint release; SGTrains; The Independent SG; Mothership; MTI; MSS/SIIA haze advisories.

Property: Malay Mail; 99.co Insider (99-SRX Flash Report); EdgeProp; Stacked Homes; The Edge Singapore; URA PR26-51.

Technology: CNBC, Investing.com/BigGo Finance, Tom's Hardware (SK hynix, HBM pricing); TechTimes, WCCFTech (GPU pricing); TechNode, DeepSeek API docs, TechCrunch, ThursdAI (frontier models).

Kit / Connected Home: 9to5Google (Eufy); VR.org (Galaxy Unpacked); home-assistant.io (2026.7 changelog); AppleHomeAuthority.com, MacDailyNews; MatterAlpha.com.

Good Life / Screen & Sound: Travel And Tour World, The Flight Club, Mainly Miles (SIA); Ultrasone.com, ecoustics.com; WatchPro, Robb Report, Dmarge (Daytona); Billboard, Variety, Boxoffice Pro, Deadline, ComingSoon.net, Metacritic, Paste Magazine.

Family: *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*, 2026; Medical Daily; Kodely; ClinicalTrials.gov (NCT06777823).

Macro: Forbes, CNBC (Fed minutes); TradingKey, MUFG Research, LiteFinance; IG UK (earnings calendar).

Curiosities: ScienceDaily, Live Science, Smithsonian Magazine (goblin shark); NASA Science, Space.com, phys.org (Webb/Centaurus A).

Love & Life: Taflinger & Hudde, *European Sociological Review*, 2026; Peetz, *Journal of Marriage and Family*, 2026.

Fitness: *BMJ Medicine*, 2026 (Harvard T.H. Chan); *Journal of the American Nutrition Association*, 2026 (CONCRET-MENOPA); University of Guelph / *Applied Physiology, Nutrition, and Metabolism*.

Diary / Table: YG Family, Consequence.net, JamBase (BIGBANG); Forbes, enhypenbloodsagatour.com (ENHYPEN); Eatbook.sg, HungryGoWhere, Time Out Singapore, Honeycombers (The Table).

Long Read: Akira Kurosawa, *Rashomon* (1950); Lloyd's of London company history; Herodotus, *Histories* 1.53.